

« Every setback sets you up for a greater comeback »

JEMIMAH RODRIGUES

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For nearly a decade, she has been a standout both on and off the field. On it, for her textbook cover drives that uphold Mumbai's rich legacy of batting in women's cricket. Off it, for the viral social media posts — often with a guitar in hand — that have made her one of the game's most recognisable personalities.

Beyond the attention online, from India's perspective, she has steadily become the bedrock of the middle order. Her exploits for the national side, combined with consistent performances across franchise leagues worldwide, have established her as a genuine modern-day star.

Remarkably, despite featuring in four T20 World Cups, Jemimah Rodrigues is only now set to make her ODI World Cup debut — a

dream she has nurtured ever since she watched Sachin Tendulkar return home on that unforgettable April night in 2011, carried on the shoulders of his teammates.

Now, a buoyant Jemimah, a newly signed Red Bull athlete, reflects on her journey to her first Women's ODI World Cup.

Four T20 World Cups, but this will be your first ODI World Cup. What does an ODI World Cup mean to you?

I'm really looking forward to it, and I think the wait makes it even more special.

Besides the wait, what makes the ODI World Cup stand out for you? In 2017, you were at the airport,